



LIFE AND WORKS OF JOSE RIZAL

Taft Commission chose Rizal out of several great Filipinos as the number one hero of his people.

Republic Act 1425 – the Rizal Law authored by Senator Claro M. Recto signed on June 12, 1956.

Jose Protacio Realonda Alonso Mercado Rizal - latest

José Protacio Rizal Mercado y Alonso Realonda - old

- "A child of a good family."

- born on June 19, 1861, between 11 and 12 in the evening, a few days before the full moon.

- baptized on June 22, 1861 by Fr. Rufino Collantes, while Fr. Pedro Casañas stood as his godfather.

I. JOSE RIZAL'S GENEALOGY

A. Genealogy – study of ancestry and family histories by genealogist.

B. Chinese Ancestry

- Domingo Lam-co – Rizal's paternal ancestor, native of the Chinchew district in China, baptized in the Parian church of San Gabriel on a Sunday on June 1697.
- Inez dela Rosa - wife of Lam-co, half of Lam-co's age. Her parents were Agustin Chinco and Jacinta Rafaela.

C. Mercado Clan

- Francisco Mercado y Chinco – Rizal's father, a prosperous landowner, sugar and rice planter, of Chinese-Filipino descent.
- born on May 11, 1818 in Biñan and lived to be 80 years old the youngest in a family of 13 siblings. A well-educated farmer who studied Latin and philosophy at Colegio de San Jose in Manila.
- his parents were Captain Juan Mercado (gobernadorcillo or mayor of Biñan) and Cirila Alejandra.

D. Alonso Clan

- Teodora Alonso – Rizal's mother, one of the most-highly educated women in the Philippines, an Ilocano-Tagalog-Chinese-Spanish descent, possibly even having Japanese blood.
- born on November 9, 1827 and lived to be 84 years old. Studied in Colegio de Santa Rosa, gifted woman with insights into literature, art, music and other forms of Filipino culture.
- daughter of Brigada de Quintos

Note:

- Eugenio Ursua
 - Maternal great great grandfather
 - Japanese Ancestry

E. Claveria List

- Royal Decree of 1849, a new family name was adopted upon the order of Governor General Narciso Claveria y Zaldúa. Issued on November 21, 1849 wherein the list of approved family names can be referred from the Catalogo Alfabetico de Apellidos".

- Rizal, a shortened form of Spanish word "second crop", seemed suited to Family of farmers. Originated from the word Ricial, which literally means rice field.

F. Siblings

- Jose was the 7th of 11 children and younger of the 2 boys.

1. Saturnina – oldest, married to Manuel Hidalgo and published Pascual H. Poblete's Tagalog translation of the Noli Me Tangere.

2. Paciano – oldest boy, 10 years older than Jose, a Major General in the revolutionary army and married Severina Decena.

3. Narcisa – known as Doña Sisa and can recite from memory all the poems of Jose Rizal married Antonio Lopez.

4. Olympia – married Silvestre Ubaldo, a telegraph operator in Manila.

5. Lucia – married Mariano Herbosa who died in cholera and was denied a Christian burial.



6. Maria – married Daniel Faustino Cruz.
7. Jose – our national hero.
8. Concepcion – known as Concha who died at age of 3.
9. Josefa – a spinster.
10. Trinidad – also a spinster.
11. Soledad – youngest and married Pantaleon Quintero. Studied at La Concordia College where she and Leonor Rivera were classmates.

G. Hereditary Influences

- Father
 - profound sense of self-respect
 - habit of independent thinking
 - love for work
- Mother
 - scientific ability
 - religious nature
 - spirit of self-sacrifice
 - passion for arts and literature
- Malayan Ancestors
 - love for freedom
 - innate desire to travel
 - indomitable courage
- Chinese Ancestors
 - serious nature
 - frugality
 - patience
 - love for children
- Spanish Ancestors
 - elegance of bearing
 - sensitivity to insult
 - gallantry to ladies

II. RIZAL'S EARLY CHILDHOOD

- A. At age 3 – learned alphabet and prayers from his mother Teodora, his first teacher. Other early teachers were Maestro Celestino, Maestro Lucas Padua and Leon Monroy who gave Jose introductory lessons in Latin. He was called “Ute” by his brother and sisters and “Pepe” or “Pepito” by townspeople in Calamba.
- B. At age 5 – read although not fluently, the Spanish Family bible called historia sagrada.
- C. At age 7 – wrote a comedy which highlighted his literary talent for the local fiesta and was rewarded 2 pesos.
- D. At age 8 – wrote the poem “Sa Aking mga Kabata”.
- E. At age 9 – wrote a poem “Mother’s birthday”. Sent to a boy’s school in Biñan and his teacher was Dr. Justiniano Aquino Cruz.

III. RIZAL'S FORMATIVE YEARS

A. Years in Ateneo (Escuela Pia – Ateneo Municipal – Ateneo de Manila)

- June 10, 1872, Paciano accompanied Jose to matriculate at the Ateneo de Municipal Manila. Fr. Magin Ferrando the registrar refused Jose to admit for two reasons (a) he was late for registration and (b) he appeared sickly and undersized for his age. Upon the intercession of Manuel Xerez-Burgos, nephew of Fr. Burgos, he was admitted in Ateneo.
- Rizal first boarded at Caraballo Street. A 25-minute walk from Ateneo owned by a spinster named Titay who owed Rizal family 300 pesos.
- Jose Bech – Rizal's first professor in Ateneo.
- Students in Ateneo is divided into 2 empires to fight for academic supremacy; the Roman (internos/boarders) and Carthaginian (externos/non-boarders) and Jose became the “Emperor of Carthaginian”.
- Remembered as an original thinker, creative scholar and a natural leader.
- Fr. Francisco de Paula Sanchez is Jose's favorite teacher in Ateneo. He considered him as the “best professor” in Ateneo.



- He also took private lessons at Santa Isabel College during noon recesses to improve his Spanish (3 pesos per session).
- During his education in Ateneo, his mother was imprisoned.

Note:

- Count of Monte Cristo by Alexander Dumas is the first foreign book Jose read.
- Travels in the Philippines by Dr. Feodor Jagor that criticized Spanish regime in the Philippines. It is the book that intrigued Jose and inspired to educate his countrymen.
- He was known as the "Pride of the Jesuits".

B. Years in UST

- enrolled as a philosophy and medical student. He did not shine in UST and failed to obtain high academic records.

C. Rizal's Writings

- A La Juventud Filipina (To the Philippine Youth) – won a special prize in poetry when Jose was still in Ateneo.
- Por La Educacion Recibe Lustre la Patria (Through Education Our Motherland Receives Light) – poem Jose wrote while he was in Ateneo which suggested that education is an integral part of national character.
- Alianza intima la religion y la educacion (The Intimate Alliance between Religion and Education) in which Jose expressed the importance of religion in education and to him, education without God is not true education.
- A la Virgen Maria (To the Virgin Mary) – 1st sad poem Jose wrote.
- Al Niño Jesus (To the Child Jesus) – an ode to Jesus was short and consisted of 8 verses only classified as octava real.
- In Memory of my Village – Jose recalled his joyous days of his childhood in Calamba.
- Council of the Gods an allegory that was awarded as 1st place in a competition however, decision was reversed.
- Mi Primera Inspiracion - My first inspiration, dedicated to his mother.
- The Philippines a Century Hence (Filipinas dentro de cien anos) an essay in which he attempted to predict the country's future.
- Mi Ultimo Adios (My Last Farewell) an untitled elegy but it was later entitled "Mi Ultimo Adios" by Mariano Ponce, his friend and fellow reformist.

IV. JOURNEY TO MADRID

- May 3, 1882 Jose secretly left the country aboard S.S. Salvador. He enrolled medicine at the Universidad Central de Madrid on November 3, 1882 with Professor Marquis Busto. He studied painting and sculpture at the Academy of San Carlos and drawing at the Academia de Bellas Artes de San Fernando with Professor Haes.
- Freemasonry – a worldwide fraternity where Jose was a member in the Acacia lodge No. 9 and his symbolic name was Dimasalang, which means untouchable.
- Uncle Tom's Cabin by Harriet Beecher Stowe and The Wandering Jew by Eugene Sue inspired Jose to fight for the Filipinos.

V. THE SCHOLAR'S JOURNEY

- From Madrid he went to Paris in 1885 and continued his medical studies under the famed French ophthalmologist Dr. Louis de Wecker.
- Jose wanted to perfect the German method of diagnosis so he opted to continue studying in Germany. He had a special training under Dr. Otto Becker.
- Jose attended lecture courses in the old University of Heidelberg for months only. He lived with Dr. Karl Ullmer with whom he took delightful walks every afternoon.
- Jose continued to write Noli and finished it on Berlin, Germany on February 22, 1887. Maximo Viola (savior of Noli) helped Jose in the printing of the book and one of its first copies was sent to Ferdinand Blumentritt.
- On July 5, 1887 he took a ship from Marseilles and started his journey back to the Philippines.



VI. RIZAL'S ROMANCES

1. Segunda Katigbak (Rizal's First Love)
 - Jose Rizal was only a young boy of sixteen (16) when he first fell in love, and it was with Segunda Katigbak, a girl from Lipa, Batangas and two years his junior (Teenage Puppy Love).
 - Jose met Miss K when he was accompanied by his friend, Mariano Katigbak when he visited his maternal grandmother. She was also a close friend of Olimpia (Jose's sister) in school at La Concordia College.
 - Unfortunately, Segunda was already engaged to be married to her townmate, Manuel Luz
2. Leonor Valenzuela (Invisible Letters)
 - known as Orang, his next-door neighbor and daughter of Capitan Juan and Capitana Sanday Valenzuela. She was a tall girl who carried herself with grace and elegance.
 - He eventually courted Leonor by sending her love notes, which he wrote in invisible ink made from a mixture of water and table salt. He taught Leonor how to read his letters by heating them over a lamp or a candle to allow the words to surface.
3. Leonor Rivera (Great Love and First Engagement)
 - Jose's cousin from Camiling and also a La Concordian. A daughter of Antonio Rivera, his uncle in whose house Jose lived during his junior year at UST.
 - She and Rizal eventually became engaged. In her letters, she signed her name as "Taimis" in order to hide their intimate relationship from the girl's parents.
 - Engaged with Jose but married another man, Henry Kipping.
4. Consuelo Ortega y Perez (The Madrid Flirt)
 - a daughter of a liberal minded Spanish official who once served in Manila during the Spanish era.
 - Rizal's romance with Consuelo did not turn into a serious affair; he decided to take a step back for two reasons: first, he was still engaged to Leonor Rivera at that time; and second, he was aware of his friend's (Eduardo de Leta) affection for the girl and he did not want to ruin their friendship over her.
5. O Sei San (Love at First Sight)
 - daughter of a Japanese nobleman who had a brief affair with Rizal when she was 23 and Rizal was 27. Her real name was Seiko Usui.
 - Because of his deep affection for her, Rizal was almost tempted to settle down in Japan. His 45-day sojourn in Japan was one of the happiest interludes in his life.
6. Gertrude Beckett (Contemporary Pastime)
 - blue-blooded Englishwoman who was the oldest daughter of London church organist in whose house Rizal lodged when he went to visit London.
 - Rizal enjoyed her company. Eventually their flirtatious friendship drifted towards a blossoming romance. He affectionately called her "Gettie," and in return she called him "Pettie."
 - It was an innocent pastime, not real love.
7. Suzanne Jacoby (The Naughty Boy of Brussels)
 - a Belgian woman Jose met when he stayed with the Jacoby's. One of the contributing factors that led Jose to continue writing *El Filibusterismo*.
8. Nellie Boustead (A Failed Proposal)
 - intellectual, sure of herself, attractive and serious with her religious belief. Jose almost married her when he knew Leonor Rivera's love affair.
9. Josephine Bracken (True Love in Exile)
 - Jose called her his "wife" and "dulce extranjera".
 - an 18-year-old lady Rizal met in Dapitan. Jose wanted to marry her but because of church requirements they just simply lived together.
 - A little boy of eight months was born, who lived for only three hours. Rizal named him Francisco in honor of his father, and buried the child in Dapitan.
 - married to a Filipino named Vicente Abad and died in Hong Kong due to tuberculosis.



VII. RIZAL'S NOVELS

1. Noli Me Tangere (Touch Me Not)

- Story of Philippine condition during the last decades of Spanish rule
- Inspired by Harriet Beecher Stowe's Uncle Tom's Cabin
- Berlin, Germany
- Dr. Maximo Viola- savior of Noli Me Tangere
- Elias and Salome- deleted chapter of Noli

2. El Filibusterismo (The Reign of Greed/ The Subversion)

- Dedicated to GomBurZa
- Valentin Ventura- savior of El Fili
- Ghent, Belgium

3. Makamisa

- Rizal's unfinished tagalog novel, written in a light sarcastic style and is incomplete for only two chapters are finished.

4. Dapitan

- Unfinished novel, written in ironic Spanish. He wrote it during his exile in Dapitan to depict the town life and customs.

FOR SELF-STUDY/SELF-REVIEW ONLY

A. NOLI ME TANGERE CHARACTERS:

1. Crisóstomo Ibarra -Also known in his full name as Juan Crisóstomo Ibarra y Magsalin, a Filipino who studied in Europe for 7 years, the love interest of Maria Clara. Son of the deceased Don Rafael Ibarra; Crisostomo changed his surname from Eibarramendia to Ibarra, from his ancestor's surname.
2. Elías -Ibarra's mysterious friend, a master boater, also a fugitive. He was referred to at one point as the pilot. He wants to revolutionize his country. Ibarra's grandfather condemned his grandfather of burning a warehouse, making Elias the fugitive he is.
3. María Clara-María Clara de los Santos, Ibarra's sweetheart; the illegitimate daughter of Father Dámaso and Pía Alba.
4. Father Dámaso - Also known in his full name as Dámaso Verdolagas, Franciscan friar and María Clara's biological father.
5. Don Filipo - A close relative of Ibarra, and a Filibuster.
6. Linares - A distant nephew of Don Tiburcio de Espadana, the would-be fiance of Maria Clara.
7. Captain General (no specific name)
 - The most powerful official in the Philippines, a hater of secular priests and corrupt officials, and a friend of Ibarra.
8. Captain Pablo -The Leader of the rebels, whose family was destroyed because of the Spanish.
9. Tarcilo and Bruno Brothers -whose father was killed by the Spaniards.
10. Sisa - The mother of Basilio and Crispín, who went insane after losing her sons.
11. Basilio -The elder son of Sisa.
12. Crispín - he younger son of Sisa who died from the punishment from the soldiers from the false accusation of stealing an amount of money.
13. Padre Sibyla -Hernando de la Sibyla, a Filipino friar. He is described as short and has fair skin.
14. Kaptain Tiago -Also known in his fullname as Don Santiago de los Santos the known father of María Clara but not the real one; lives in Binondo.
15. Padri Salví - Also known in his full name as Bernardo Salví, a secret admirer of María Clara.
16. Pilosopo Tasyo -Also known as Don Anastasio, portrayed in the novel as a pessimist, cynic, and mad by his neighbors.
17. The Alférez -Chief of the Guardia Civil ; mortal enemy of the priests for the power in San Diego.
18. Don Tiburcio -Spanish husband of Donya Victorina who is limp and submissive to his wife; he also pretends to be a doctor.
19. Doña Victorina -Victorina de los Reyes de De Espadaña, a woman who passes herself off as a Peninsular.



20. Doña Consolación -Wife of the Alférez, another woman who passes herself as a Peninsular; best remembered for her abusive treatment of Sisa.
21. Pedro -Abusive husband of Sisa who loves cockfighting.
22. Old Tasio - An older man who Ibarra seeks advice from. The town thinks him mad, but in actuality he is quite wise.

B. EL FILIBUSTERISMO CHARACTERS:

1. Simoun - Crisóstomo Ibarra reincarnated as a wealthy jeweler, bent on starting a revolution
2. Basilio - Sisa's son, now an aspiring doctor.
3. Isagani -poet and Basilio's best friend; portrayed as emotional and reactive; Paulita Gómez' boyfriend before being dumped for fellow student Juanito Peláez
4. Kabesang Tales - Telesforo Juan de Dios, a former cabeza de barangay (barangay head) who resurfaced as the feared Luzón bandit Matanglawin (Tagalog for Hawkeye); his father, Old Man Selo, dies eventually after his own son Tano, who became a guardia civil, unknowingly shoots his grandfather in an encounter
5. Don Custodio -Custodio de Salazar y Sánchez de Montereondo, a famous journalist who was asked by the students about his decision for the Academia de Castellano. In reality, he is quite an ordinary fellow who married a rich woman in order to be a member of Manila's high society
6. Paulita Gómez -the girlfriend of Isagani and the niece of Doña Victorina, the old India who passes herself off as a Peninsular, who is the wife of the quack doctor Tiburcio de Espadaña. In the end, she and Juanito Peláez are wed, and she dumps Isagani, believing that she will have no future if she marries him
7. Father Florentino -Isagani's godfather, and a secular priest; was engaged to be married, but chose the priesthood instead, the story hinting at the ambivalence of his decision as he chooses an assignment to a remote place, living in solitude near the sea.
8. Huli -Juliana de Dios, the girlfriend of Basilio, and the youngest daughter of Kabesang Tales
9. Ben Zayb -Abraham Ibañez is his real name. He is a journalist who thinks he is the only one thinking in the Philippines
10. Placido Penitente - a student of the University of Santo Tomas who is always miserable, and therefore controls his temper
11. Quiroga -a Chinese businessman who dreamt of being a consul of a Consulate of China in the Philippines. He hid Simoun's weapons inside his house
12. Old Man Selo - father of Kabesang Tales. He raised the sick and young Basilio after his mother Sisa had died
13. Father Fernandez -the priest-friend of Isagani. He promised to Isagani that he and the other priests will give in to the students' demands
14. Attorney Pasta -one of the great lawyers of mid-Hispanic Manila
15. Padre Sibyla -Hernando de la Sibyla, a Filipino friar and now vice-rector of the University of Santo Tomas (U.S.T.)